

ORBWALKER

Game Design Booklet

Match-3 Roguelike • PC + Mobile



HIGH CONCEPT

A fantasy match-3 roguelike where free orb movement meets run-based progression. Battle through ever-changing dungeons, build your hero with equipment and mastery, use powerful consumables, discover relics, visit shops, and confront challenging bosses.



DREADHORN BRUTE

6,240 / 8,800



DESIGN PILLARS



FREE MOVEMENT PUZZLE COMBAT

Drag orbs anywhere—create matches, trigger powerful effects, defeat foes.



BUILD-DRIVEN PROGRESSION

Equip gear, unlock mastery, collect relics, and shape unique builds each run.



CLEAR ENEMY INTENT

Readable telegraphs and behaviors help you plan, adapt, and overcome.



SHORT, READABLE DECISIONS

Every turn is easy to grasp, every choice has impact.



FANTASY-FIRST PRESENTATION

Rich world, elemental magic, and a premium visual experience.



PLAYER FANTASY

You are a fantasy hero—wielding the power of elemental orbs to outsmart and overpower your enemies. With every run you grow stronger, equipping mighty gear and unlocking mastery that turns you into a legend.



ORB TYPES



FIRE



ICE



EARTH



HEART



ARMOR



GOLD

ORBWALKER CORE GAME FLOW

— ♦ How a run progresses from turn to turn ♦ —

1 FIGHT LOOP



2 DUNGEON LEVEL LOOP



♦ Target full run: 10 dungeon levels. Level 10 ends with the main boss. ♦

3 RUN LOOP



Meta progression unlocks new equipment and relics rather than flat permanent power.



DESIGN INTENT



Short, readable turns that respect the player's time.



Strategic routing and decisions under time pressure.



Roguelike build variety across the run through equipment, relics, and orb synergies.

ORBWALKER

PUZZLE COMBAT SYSTEM

Board rules, orb movement, matches, and combat values

1. BOARD RULES

5 columns × 6 rows

Gravity flows downward

New orbs refill from the top

Starting boards avoid automatic matches

Cascades are valid and trigger real combo effects



2. ORB MOVEMENT

- ◆ Select one orb
- ◆ Drag through adjacent cells
- ◆ Passed-through orbs are displaced/swapped
- ◆ Horizontal and vertical only
- ◆ No diagonal movement
- ◆ Move ends on release or timer expiry



3. MATCH RULES

HORIZONTAL LINE OF 3+



Match 3 or more in a horizontal line.

VERTICAL LINE OF 3+



Match 3 or more in a vertical line.

L SHAPE



Match 3 or more in an L shape.

T SHAPE



Match 3 or more in a T shape.



Only same-type connected orbs count. Diagonal connections do not count.

4. ORB TYPES & EFFECTS



FIRE

= damage



ICE

= damage



EARTH

= damage



HEART

= healing



ARMOR

= defense



GOLD

= currency



Gold orbs are rarer than other orb types.

5. FORMULA SNAPSHOT

Base Amount = Orb Count × (Mastery Level + 1)

Combo Multiplier = (Increase Combo Modifier + Combo Count) × More Combo Modifier

Total Damage / Armor = Base Amount × Combo Multiplier

Heart and Gold do not use combo scaling

EXAMPLE



3 Fire orbs with 3 combos = 9 damage at mastery level 0.

Base Amount = $3 \times (0 + 1) = 3$

Combo Multiplier = $(0 + 3) \times 1 = 3$

Total Damage = $3 \times 3 = 9$

PROGRESSION, ECONOMY & BUILDS

How the player grows stronger during a run

1. CORE PROGRESSION PILLARS



EQUIPMENT

Passive build-defining gear.

5 starting slots, no duplicates.



MASTERY

Permanent per-run upgrades to each orb type.

Prototype cap level 5.



CONSUMABLES

Single-use board manipulation tools.

3 slots.



RELICS

Rare run-changing modifiers obtained from bosses and shops.



2. SHOP & ECONOMY

- Gold persists through the whole run.
- Gold mainly comes from matching Gold orbs.
- After each fight, enter a shop.
- Default shop: 3 random item slots + 1 relic offer.
- Actions: buy, buy boosters, reroll, sell equipment for full value.
- After first enemy, player should usually afford at least 1 booster if some gold was matched.

SHOP

\$ 243

\$ 120	\$ 160	\$ 90	\$ 250

BUY BOOSTERS

REROLL

SELL EQUIPMENT

\$ 80

\$ 30

FULL VALUE

3. BOOSTERS



- Buy a pack, reveal 3 options, pick 1.
- Element boosters focus on one orb type.
- Category boosters focus on Equipment, Mastery, or Consumables.
- Relics are usually not in booster pools.

4. SAMPLE PROGRESSION CONTENT

EQUIPMENT EXAMPLES



Sword Buckler Cuirass Ember Ring Combo Lens

Passive gear that shapes your strategy and synergies.

MASTERY EXAMPLES



Fire Ice Earth Heart Armor Gold Mastery

Invest to permanently boost orb effects, gain new effects, and reach higher tiers.



CONSUMABLE EXAMPLES



Fire Scroll Ice Scroll Earth Scroll Gold Scroll

Powerful single-use effects to alter the board or generate advantage.

RELIC EXAMPLES



Deep Pockets Stalwart Mantle Golden Idol Merchant Compass

Rare relics that can dramatically change how a run unfolds.

5. RUN PROGRESSION FLOW



6. META PROGRESSION



Between runs, unlock new equipment and relics, and later possibly heroes, dungeons, and ascension levels to expand what's possible in future runs.

SCREEN CONCEPTS

◆ Key UI screens for the first playable prototype ◆

COMBAT SCREEN

DREADHORN BRUTE
6,240 / 8,800

ENEMY & INTENT ICON

ENEMY HP BAR

5x6 ORB BOARD

MOVE TIMER (5 SECONDS)

PLAYER HP & ARMOR
3,450 / 3,450 220

EQUIPMENT SLOTS (5)

CONSUMABLE SLOTS (3)

COMBAT FEEDBACK (DAMAGE / COMBO)

COMBO x3
+480 DAMAGE

SHOP SCREEN

1,285

GOLD TOTAL

ITEMS FOR SALE

Ironclad Mail Armor 320

Frostbite Ring Accessory 260

Ember Blade Weapon 410

RANDOM ITEMS (3 SLOTS)

RELIC OFFER

Ancient Idol
Start battles with 1 Armor and +15% damage. 600

RELIC OFFER

BOOSTER PACK

Adventurer's Pack
Contains 3 random consumables. 150

BOOSTER PACK

REROLL (1) 50

REROLL BUTTON

INVENTORY SUMMARY

5 5 4 4 3 2 1 1

INVENTORY / EQUIPMENT SUMMARY



FIRST PLAYABLE PROTOTYPE

- ◆ 3 dungeon levels
- ◆ One hero
- ◆ All 6 orb types
- ◆ Free orb movement + cascades
- ◆ Enemy intent
- ◆ Shop after each fight
- ◆ Equipment, mastery, consumables, relics
- ◆ At least 3 normal enemies and 3 bosses



INITIAL ENEMY & BOSS DIRECTION

NORMAL ENEMIES

Readable cycles and clear intent telegraphs.



BOSS ARCHETYPES

Each boss tests a different mastery path.

